THE HOLLOW HEIR

Day 2 Book

Day 2: The first victim

Mandrakes, a charming teacher, two puzzles, and a scream in the night. Everything for one session, start to finish.

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PART 1

Before you start

Ten minutes before the players arrive.

This book is the whole of Day 2 in one place: what to read aloud, what to press, who is where, what each family gets to do, two puzzles, and what to do when the players go off-script. You should not need any other book tonight. The DM Guide and the Guidebook are still there if you want the bigger picture.

One day is one session

Day 2 fits comfortably in one evening of three to four hours. It has two classes (short), two exploring blocks (long), and ends on the best cliffhanger in the first half of the campaign. Stop there. Do not press Advance time after the scene: the new morning (full HP, recharged gifts, the House of the Day) is how next session begins.

Block	Aim for	If you are running late
Breakfast (recap and intro)	10 minutes	Skip the recap; read the intro only.
Morning class: Herbology	20 minutes	Play the minigame, read one line, move on.
Lunch	40 minutes	Two things per group, then call the bell.
Afternoon class: Defence	20 minutes	Same as Herbology.
Free time	60 minutes	Drop the second Dueling Club round; keep the prefect.
Curfew: two games, then the scream	50 to 60 minutes	Play only the Portrait round; skip the staircases puzzle.
Wrap-up and save	10 minutes	Never skip this.

The checklist

- Double-click **Start Game Night.bat**. Open the address on the TV and your GM screen. Players sign in on their phones.
- Open the game. The clock should still say **Day 1, Curfew**. If it does, press **Advance time** once now, with everyone watching: it is a new morning. Everyone is healed, gifts recharge, and the House of the Day is drawn (the TV announces it).
- Crown **Day 1's MVP** on the **MVP** tab if you have not yet (Inzaw, the Okafor: he found his way out of the dark, went back in for everyone, and won the most points). Do it with everyone watching: it goes on the TV, and his +2 Badge works all of today.
- Have ready: your tarot deck, the garden rune tablet, any owl letters you printed, and a sticky note per player for spotlight ticks.
- Check the **Quests** tab for anything still open from Day 1 (see Carry-overs below).
- Glance at the TV **Shows** tab: the suspect board should show what they pinned on Day 1.

Carry-overs from Day 1

Keep an Eye Out (Prefect Sinclair)	**Accepted, and they walked her patrol route on Day 1.** Tick the first two objectives (meet her, follow the patrol). One is left: find what she is afraid of. That happens today in Free time on the Grand Staircase, when she shows them the empty frames. It ends at the end of Free time.
Stolen Ingredients (Grimsby): DONE	The Blackwood found the jar. The Penrose saw him pick it up, marched him to Grimsby and accused him of stealing it. Grimsby believed her and would not let him explain. The Blackwood told him: "As a teacher you should be ashamed to think a Blackwood would do such a low act," and walked out. Meanwhile the Fenwick tried talking to Peeves politely, and Peeves simply vanished. Mark it complete. The fallout plays out today: see **The jar: what happens now** in Part 5.
The Fenwick's map, and the professor	A professor noticed the Fenwick's map on Day 1 and asked to meet him. That meeting happens today: see **The Fenwick's map** in Part 5. The map itself already works: if the Fenwick says the right words, it opens (see below).
Borish the ghost	The Fenwick made friends with the castle ghost on Day 1: **Borish**, who was a student when the school was first founded, knows a great deal and remembers almost none of it. He is in Part 5 too. Today he turns up wherever the Fenwick is lonely.
The first rune tablet	The Thornbury found it but has not looked at it yet. When the second one turns up in the Greenhouses today, nudge him: "The slate in your bag feels heavier than it should." Two tablets side by side is when the runes start to make sense.
The Library chest	Opened by the Sinclair with a natural 20. Gone.
The Restricted Section	The Okafor slipped past the librarian under the cloak on Day 1, but the chained gate would not open. He knows where it is now, and he will be back: see **The Restricted Section** in Free time.
Tarot from Day 1	The Okafor drew three reversed: cursed (Cups). Done: he lost 6 HP and chose the Thornbury to lose 5. The Thornbury borrowed 5 Galleons from the Quill and drew a **Favour of Pentacles**: the next chest he opens gives double, or one shop item is free. Remind him when he opens a chest today.
Whatever is on your paper notes	You entered these on the laptop during the dry run. If anything is missing, fix it now on the GM screen before anyone looks at their phone.

From their diaries

Three students handed in Day 1 diaries (the Okafor, the Penrose and the Sinclair). What they noticed, and what to do with it today:

Both the Okafor and the Penrose saw the painting moved	Two figures carrying something under a red cloth to the Dungeons, coming back with nothing. Two diaries agree: pin **"The covered painting hangs in a different corridor each night"** under The covered painting before you start.
The Okafor: "the mirror contains an item, requires an alliance between the Houses"	He is right, and today proves it: the Silver Memory (Free time, the Library).
The Okafor: "forbidden spell requires runes, behind 3 puzzles"	His own theory. Let him be half right: the three tablets really do teach the letters that open the door beneath the castle. Don't confirm it; let the runes do it.
The Penrose: "boomslang skin and lacewing flies stolen"	She has guessed Polyjuice: someone wants to look like someone else. Let her keep the theory. On Day 4, when the Painted Double appears, she will think she called it.
The Penrose: "Scamander may be related"	She suspects a family link through the suitcase. Save the moment for Day 3's Care of Magical Creatures, when Scamander sees the suitcase: "Where did you get that? I've only ever seen one like it."

The Penrose: “Boris’s ghost finds hidden items”	She calls him Boris. The Fenwick can correct her. Borish doesn’t mind either way.
The Sinclair: “my sister has bad dreams about paintings”	She is carrying the dread that pays off tonight. Give her the quiet moments with her sister at Lunch and on the Grand Staircase.
The Sinclair: “key in my vault, the goblin looks at me in a certain way”	A thread from Gringotts waiting to matter. An owl from home can mention it any time: “The key in the vault was your great-aunt’s. Keep it close.” What it opens is yours to decide later.
The Sinclair: “house with high points will get a perk or a clue”	True: the House of the Day perks include a free hint. Make sure Ravenclaw notices when it wins one.

TIP

Only three diaries came in. Next session, say out loud that diaries count: +5 house points for every diary handed in at the start of the night. The best ones get read aloud by Borish, who loves a good story and forgets the endings.

Morning rolls (secret gifts)

Two secret gifts roll every morning. Do them quietly before the breakfast intro.

The Sinclair (Fashionably Late)	Roll a d20. On 1 to 6 they are late for Herbology: −5 house points, and Longbottom says their name in a disappointed voice. On 7 or more they are, for once, on time, and everyone notices.
The Penrose (The Battered Suitcase)	Roll a d20. On 1 to 4 something got out in the night. Use the table below. Tell the Penrose privately; let them decide whether to tell the others.

d4	What escaped	Where, and what it does today
1	A Niffler	The Great Hall at Lunch. Galleons go missing from the tables. Catch it (DEX 12, or bribe it with a shiny thing) before Vance does. Fail: −5 points and a very long look.
2	A Bowtruckle	The Greenhouses in Herbology. It is hiding among the Mandrakes and picking the locks on the seed cupboards. The Fenwick can ask the plants where it is.
3	An Occamy	Coiled in the rafters of Ashgrove’s classroom. It has grown to fill the space it found. Ashgrove is delighted and wants to keep it; getting it back without him asking questions is the challenge.
4	Something small and furry	Following Mrs Norris around the Entrance Hall. Filch is convinced it is a student’s rat and is hunting for the owner. (A Thornbury can ask the castle’s rats to help herd it.)

ON THE GM SCREEN

If it is not caught by Curfew, a teacher catches it: the suitcase is confiscated until Day 4 (put it in your notes). Scamander would very much like to know where they got it.

Sound for tonight (Thaumaturgy)

Optional, and free: **thaumaturgy.app** plays background sound and sound effects in a browser tab. Run it on the laptop beside the GM screen, through the TV or a speaker. It has 119 ready-made **environments** (background sound you leave running) and 67 **boards** (buttons for one-off sounds). Set up a **scene** for each place below before the night, then switching is one tap.

When	Environment (leave running)	Board buttons to have ready
Breakfast, Lunch	**Great Hall**, with its Feasting layer turned on.	Birds & omens: an owl for the morning post.
Herbology (Greenhouses)	**Rainy Woods**, quiet: rain on glass and leaves. No greenhouse is built in, so this is the closest.	Upload a Mandrake cry of your own (a baby crying, pitched up) for when a pot is pulled. Kitchen & Camp Cooking for pots and trowels.
Ashgrove's classroom (Lunch, Defence)	**Great Hall** at low volume, with the **Whispers** layer from **Crypt** added very quietly. Nobody will notice the whispers until somebody does.	Magic for Expelliarmus and the class duels.
The Dueling Club	**Great Hall** with Feasting (Laughter) on: a crowd.	Magic and Combat. A cheer or groan for each win.
The Wailing Mandrake fight	Keep **Rainy Woods** on.	Your Mandrake cry for when it springs (the app's own scream plays on the TV too). Combat for hits.
The Library, tarot	Build one: **Quiet hearth** + **Footsteps: stone**, very low. Add page-turns from the book sounds.	Magic for the tarot reveal. Ghost & spirits for Borish.
The Silver Memory	**Feywild Glade**, faded in slowly as they pour, faded out when the memory ends.	Nothing. Let it be quiet.
The Restricted Section	**Crypt** with Bones off and Whispers on, or **Ancient Tomb**.	Doors & Traps for the gate and the chains. Bones & the Dead if a chained book bites.
Curfew: common rooms, the Painted Double game	The **Quiet hearth** layer alone, or **Tavern** turned right down.	Nothing. Silence before the scream matters.
The scream	Press **STOP ALL** (or Esc) first. A second of total silence.	Your own scream, uploaded to a board (MP3 or WAV). Or the scream sound on the app's Media tab.
The Moving Staircases	**Haunted Corridor** (creaking wood, distant wails).	Doors & Traps for a stair crashing round on a wrong turn. Alarms & Signals for Filch.
The tower corridor, the drained prefect	**Haunted Corridor** at half volume, Accent (wails) off.	Nothing. Read it over the quiet.

TIP

Things it does not have built in: a Mandrake, Peeves, a Hogwarts-style bell, and your scream. Upload your own (MP3, OGG, WAV or FLAC) under **Your own sounds** on its Play screen; they stay in your browser unless you sign in. Check each environment name on its Environments screen the first time: if one is missing, the nearest one by name will do.

PART 2

Day 2 at a glance

Mandrakes, a charming teacher, and a scream in the night.

Block	What happens	Where	You press
Morning class	Herbology with Longbottom. Mandrake care: 1 Mandrake leaf.	Greenhouses	Start class minigame (Mandrake Repotting)
Lunch	Ashgrove shows off his portraits. Wren Ashby offers Card Collector. Puzzle: the Scrambled Portrait.	Defence classroom, Great Hall	Quests tab; Puzzles tab
Afternoon class	Defence with Ashgrove. Teaches Expelliarmus.	Defence classroom	Start class minigame (Duel Reflexes)
Free time	Dueling Club. Second rune tablet, and a mimic in the Greenhouses: the Wailing Mandrake. Prefect Sinclair's last warning. Tarot.	Great Hall, Greenhouses, Grand Staircase, Library	Fight on the Table tab; Tarot tab
Curfew	Puzzle: the Moving Staircases. Prefect Sinclair is found drained.	Grand Staircase, Ravenclaw Tower	Puzzles tab; Quests (The Hollow Heir)

What the app does by itself today

- Every Advance time moves everyone to their place for the block (the lists in Part 3 match it).
- Free time: the **second rune tablet** and a spare-looking **Mandrake leaf** (the Wailing Mandrake, a mimic) appear in the Greenhouses, and a **Dueling Club rival** appears in the Great Hall (gone at the end of the block).
- Quests on offer turn up on the Quests tab when their time comes. Anything not picked up in time arrives by **owl** at the start of the next block.
- Curfew: Prefect Sinclair is placed in the Ravenclaw common room.

Quests on offer today

Quest	From	On offer	Reward
Keep an Eye Out	Prefect Sinclair	Patrol done. Last objective in Free time today	30 XP, 10 points
Card Collector	Wren Ashby	From Lunch (to Day 5)	25 XP, Felix Felicis, and a secret
Dueling Club Champion	Professor Flitwick	From Free time (to Day 4 Lunch)	40 XP, 15 points each
Clear the Blackwood's name (optional)	You (no quest card)	Any time today	Grimsby's grudging respect
The Hollow Heir (main)	Everyone	After the scene at Curfew	The rest of the campaign

PART 3

The day, block by block

Read the grey boxes aloud. Everything else is for you.

Breakfast

WAIT FOR THE PLAYERS

"Before we start: what happened yesterday? Tell me." Let the players recap Day 1. Fill in only what they forget. It is the best warm-up there is, and it tells you what they think matters.

READ ALOUD

Morning. The greenhouses are steaming in the cold, and somewhere inside them, something is screaming in a very small voice. Everyone is talking about Professor Ashgrove: the friendliest teacher in the castle, with a classroom full of paintings that seem to lean in when you pass. And tonight, after dinner, Professor Flitwick is pinning a notice to the Great Hall doors. A Dueling Club. Only the bravest need sign up. Keep your wits about you today. The portraits have gone strangely quiet near Ravenclaw Tower.

ON THE GM SCREEN

This points them to the Greenhouses, Ashgrove's classroom, the Dueling Club and (without them knowing) the place of tonight's scene. If the House of the Day perk gives them something, hand it over now with a flourish.

Morning class: Herbology

Greenhouses	Professor Longbottom
Entrance Hall	Filch, the ghost
Grand Staircase	Peeves
Library	The librarian, Professor Greaves (tarot)
Elsewhere	Other teachers in their classrooms

READ ALOUD

Greenhouse Three is warm and damp and smells of earth. Professor Longbottom is up to his elbows in soil, laughing at something a plant has just done. On the benches, rows of pots. Something in one of them is crying.

IN CHARACTER: PROFESSOR LONGBOTTOM

"Earmuffs on, everyone! These are Mandrakes. Their cry won't kill you at this age, but it'll ruin your afternoon. Gently does it."

Running the class

- On the **Day & class** tab, tick who is attending (anyone who skipped or is late misses it).
- Press **Start class minigame**: **Mandrake Repotting**. Mandrakes pop up; tap them back down before they scream. Three screams and you faint. Two attempts each.
- Passing gives a **Mandrake leaf** and 10 XP automatically. Tell them to keep it: on Day 3 three leaves can wake the drained (they do not know that yet).
- Press **End class**.

The Fenwick (Green Thumb)	Their spotlight. They roll with advantage here, know every plant on sight, and can use their daily gift to ask a Mandrake to stay quiet: a free pass for them or a friend. Longbottom notices: "You've a gift. Come and see me any time." They can learn a Herbology spell from him later.
Someone takes their earmuffs off	The Mandrake screams. CON 12 or Stunned for a round, and everyone laughs except them.
They poke the other plants	Something with teeth snaps (1 HP). Something else sneezes glittering pollen; they sneeze for an hour.
They help Longbottom tidy up	He chats happily and mentions the painting Ashgrove gave him for his office: "lovely thing". Nothing odd yet. (On Day 6 he admits it kept changing.)
They ask for a second leaf	A good CHA or a real reason ("for the Hospital Wing") and he gives one. Otherwise: "One each. They're precious."
The Sinclair was late	They arrive mid-lesson, covered in mud from a shortcut. The class is half done; they get one attempt, not two.

Lunch

Great Hall	The Headmaster, Flitwick, Grimsby, Longbottom, Vance, Scamander, Hooch, Peeves, the ghost, Wren Ashby, Prefect Sinclair, Cassius
Defence classroom	Professor Ashgrove, with his portraits
Entrance Hall	Filch
Library	The librarian, Professor Greaves
Kitchens	Pip the house-elf
Hospital Wing	The matron

Two things each. Lunch is for exploring and talking. Let them split up; move each group with the Move tick boxes.

READ ALOUD

At lunch, a crowd of students has gathered at the door of the Defence classroom. Professor Ashgrove is showing them his paintings: landscapes, old wizards, a ship in a storm. He tells a story for every one. Everybody is laughing. In the back row of frames, one portrait is not.

IN CHARACTER: PROFESSOR ASHGROVE

"I collect them! Every one has a story. Some of them are even true."

Ashgrove's classroom

They count the paintings	Twenty-three. Tomorrow there will be twenty-six. Nobody sees him hang them. Pin **"Ashgrove's classroom has more paintings every day"** when they notice the change (tomorrow), or now if they are suspicious enough to write the number down.
The Quill asks what here is hidden or enchanted	"Every painting in this room. All of them." Nothing more specific. The Quill feels watched by twenty-three pairs of eyes.
The Blackwood asks the spiders (Spider-Speech)	The spiders in the corners whisper, and they will not go near the back row: "Cold ones. Watching ones. We do not go there." (They want paying: a food item from the Bag.)
Someone asks a portrait a question	It answers, but looks at Ashgrove first, as if for permission. That has never happened before.
They ask Ashgrove where he got them	He touches his left cuff (he always does before a lie). "Oh, here and there. Auctions, attics. Paintings find their way to people who love them."
They are rude about the paintings	He laughs it off. One of the paintings behind him does not.

The Great Hall

They meet Wren Ashby	She is sorting Chocolate Frog cards with ink-stained fingers. Offer **Card Collector**: "I'm missing one. A rare. Find it for me and I'll tell you something about the painting nobody else knows." She identifies any card they show her instantly.
They talk to Prefect Sinclair	Tired, brushing it off. To the Sinclair, quietly: "I didn't sleep. The portraits outside the tower… they've stopped talking. All of them." She remembers last night's patrol: "Find me on the Grand Staircase after dinner. I want to show you something."
Cassius picks a fight	"First-years in the Dueling Club. That'll be quick." He wants them to sign up so he can beat them in front of everyone.
They ask the Headmaster about anything	He answers the worry behind the question, not the question. He offers a sherbet lemon.
They try to talk to Grimsby	He is reading a book on draughts and slams it shut. To the Penrose, a curt nod (she is the "honest one"). To the Blackwood, nothing at all: he looks straight through him. See **The jar: what happens now**.
Students whisper about the Blackwood	Word has got round. Two Hufflepuffs go quiet when he sits down; Cassius drawls, "Nicked anything good today, Blackwood?" It stings. Let the player decide how the Blackwood carries it.
A Niffler is loose (Penrose roll)	Galleons vanish from the Hufflepuff table. Then the Ravenclaw table. Then Vance's plate.

Puzzle: The Scrambled Portrait

Where: the corridor between the Great Hall and the Defence classroom. Offer it to whoever walks that way, or to anyone who seems stuck. It takes one of their two Lunch actions.

READ ALOUD

Halfway down the corridor, a portrait has been sliced into nine squares and shuffled in its frame. One square is missing. A muffled voice comes from somewhere inside the mess: "Peeves! It was Peeves! Put me back, I beg you, I cannot find my own nose!"

- On the **Puzzles** tab, start **The Scrambled Portrait**. The picture appears on the TV.
- The players name a piece next to the gap; you tap it to slide it in. Talking it through together is the point.
- Hints, if they are stuck: "Fix the top row first, then the left column." Then: "Leave the last two rows until the end; turn them like a wheel." Last resort: make the next three moves for them.
- It is solved when pieces 1 to 8 are in order with the gap last (16 slides at best). There is no way to fail.

READ ALOUD

The last square slides home. The old witch in the portrait blinks, touches her nose with enormous relief, and then leans out of her frame, as close as she can get. Her voice drops to a whisper. "Thank you, children. Now listen. He did not arrive on the train. He was brought. And he has been hungry for a very long time."

ON THE GM SCREEN

Reward: +10 house points to each student who helped, and a tick on their spotlight note. If they ask who "he" is, she glances at the Defence classroom door, goes pale (as pale as paint can go), and says nothing more. That glance is the clue.

Afternoon class: Defence

Defence classroom	Professor Ashgrove
Dungeons	Grimsby, Peeves
Trophy Room	Filch
Grand Staircase	The ghost
Forbidden Forest	The centaur
Library	The librarian, Professor Greaves

READ ALOUD

Professor Ashgrove's classroom is warm and bright and full of paintings. He is the kind of teacher who remembers your name on the first day. He perches on the edge of his desk.

IN CHARACTER: PROFESSOR ASHGROVE

"Defence is not about fighting. It is about making sure the fight never reaches you. Now. Wands up. Expelliarmus!"

Running the class

- Tick who is attending, then **Start class minigame**: **Duel Reflexes**. Spells fly at them: red means Shield, blue means Dodge, gold means Counter. Trust the colour, not the word. Ten spells, two mistakes allowed.
- Passing teaches **Expelliarmus** (3 mana, d20 + DEX to hit; on a hit, the target's next attack misses) and 10 XP.
- They will want to use it at the Dueling Club straight after. Good.

Someone does well	Ashgrove is delighted: +5 house points, and he says something kind and specific about them ("You don't flinch. That's rarer than talent."). They will remember it on Day 6.
Someone fails	He kneels beside them and helps, patiently. He is a genuinely good teacher. That is what makes it hurt later.
They watch the paintings during class	One painting's figure has turned its head to watch the student who is not paying attention. When they look straight at it, it is facing forward again.
They search his desk after class	He is still in the room, marking. DEX 15 to do it while he isn't looking (DEX 13 if a friend keeps him talking). Inside: marking, a paint-stained rag that is still wet, and a sketch of a cold stone corridor that he does not remember drawing.
The Okafor uses the Invisibility Cloak to search	They can do it unseen, no roll. But under the cloak, standing that close to the back row of paintings, they feel the same thing their mother felt: something in there is awake.
The Penrose sends a Niffler or Bowtruckle	The creature brings back the wet rag. It is shaking and will not go near the back row again.
The Quill sends their Mirror Self in instead	The illusion walks the room. Every painting in the back row turns to watch it, not the real students. The Quill feels it: they are being studied.

Free time

Great Hall	Professor Flitwick (Dueling Club), a Dueling Club rival
Library	The librarian, Wren Ashby, Professor Greaves
Grand Staircase	The ghost, Prefect Sinclair
Greenhouses	Professor Longbottom, the second rune tablet
Courtyard	Peeves
Elsewhere	Grimsby in the Dungeons, Ashgrove in his classroom, Filch in the Trophy Room

Three things each. This is the big exploring block of the day. Ask each group where they go. The four big draws are below; the rest is theirs.

IN CHARACTER: PROFESSOR FLITWICK

"Dueling Club! Every evening in the Great Hall. Fair fights, friendly spells, nobody gets stunned into next week. Well. Rarely."

The Dueling Club (Great Hall)

- Give **Dueling Club Champion** to anyone who signs up. The rival is already on the map.
- Start the fight from the **Table** tab. For a duel that feels like a duel, turn on the **reaction duel** on the rival's token.
- **Dueling Club rival:** 14 HP, Defence 12, +3 to hit, 1d6 damage, +2 initiative, 15 XP.
- Flitwick referees from a pile of books, squeaking advice. Nobody is badly hurt: at 0 HP a student just sits down, dazed, and loses the round.

They duel the rival	A fair fight with Expelliarmus fresh in their hands. Winners are cheered; losers get a pat and a Chocolate Frog (which might hold Wren's rare card: roll a d20, 18+).
Two want to fight together	Flitwick allows it: "Two against one, how exciting!"
Someone psyches the rival out first	CHA 12: advantage on their first spell.
The Quill uses Mirror Self	The first spell that would hit them hits the illusion, which pops in a shower of sparks. The crowd gasps. Flitwick falls off his books.
Cassius watches	He sneers. If a student beats the rival: "Not bad. For a first-year." And walks off. He is the final of the quest, later in the week.
They want to fight Cassius now	"Not today, firstie. Win a couple first. I don't waste my time."

The Grand Staircase: Prefect Sinclair's last warning

This matters more than anything else in Free time. If Keep an Eye Out is still open, she finds them even if they do not come to her. The players who walk with her now are the ones who will feel tonight.

READ ALOUD

Prefect Sinclair is standing on a landing of the Grand Staircase with her wand lit, although it is not yet dark. She is looking at an empty frame. She jumps when she hears you.

IN CHARACTER: PREFECT SINCLAIR

"Oh. It's you. Good. Look at this. And this one. And that one." She points at frame after empty frame. "They were all full yesterday. I think something's going to happen. Tonight. I don't know what. I just know."

They walked the patrol with her last night	They did. So tonight she skips it and takes them straight to what scares her: the empty frames on this landing, then a dead end near the Dungeons where the air is so cold their breath mists. "That's where it's worst. Under there, somewhere." Tick the last objective on Keep an Eye Out and complete it: 30 XP and 10 points each.
The Sinclair talks to her alone	She drops the act. "I'm scared. Don't tell Mum." She ruffles their hair, too hard, and laughs, too loud.
They offer to stay with her tonight	She refuses, kindly and firmly: "I'm a prefect. You're first-years. Bed." (See "If they try to stop it" in Part 4.)
They give her a Chocolate Frog	She actually smiles. +5 points. She keeps the card "for luck".
The Thornbury sends a rat to follow her (Rat-Speech)	At the start of Curfew, the rat comes back trembling: "The pictures went out. All of them. Then something came down the wall that was not a person."

The Greenhouses: the second rune tablet

A mossy slate wedged under a seed tray: three pictures (an apple, a pine tree, a toad) with their names written in runes underneath. Longbottom lets them keep it.

- It goes into the finder's Bag. Hand over the clay slate too. They work the runes out on their own paper, side by side with the Library tablet.
- The words are APPLE, PINE and TOAD. Between them: A, P, L, E, I, N, T, O and D.
- Do not confirm it the moment it is picked up. Let them argue on paper. When they tell you what the words say and you say "correct", open **Rune notebook** on the Puzzles tab and confirm the tablet: the TV announces the new runes.

The Fenwick asks the plants (Green Thumb)	The grass tells them who walked past last night: "Heavy boots. Smelled of turpentine. Went to the castle, not from it."
They search the Greenhouses for more leaves	DEX 12 to take a Mandrake leaf unseen. Fail: the Mandrakes scream, and Longbottom sighs and gives them one anyway, with a lecture.

Mimic: the Wailing Mandrake (Greenhouses)

Today's mimic is made for Day 2, and it takes nothing that matters. The app places it by itself at the start of Free time: on the map and the phones it is just a **Mandrake leaf** lying in the soil by a bench, a little way from the rune tablet. After this morning's class, everyone knows those leaves are precious.

READ ALOUD

Near the end of the potting bench, a single fat Mandrake leaf pokes out of a pot of loose soil, as if someone had forgotten it. It is a very good leaf. It would be a shame to leave it.

- It springs the moment anyone taps **Pick up**: the TV goes black, a maw lunges out with a scream, every phone buzzes red, and the fight starts with the Mandrake acting first (a Sinclair still goes first).
- **The Wailing Mandrake:** 24 HP, Defence 12, +4 to hit, 1d6. **Every hit steals the target's voice:** they are **Silenced** for a turn, so no spells. The app puts it on them and the TV says so.
- **When it is beaten** it wilts into the soil and leaves **three real Mandrake leaves** on the floor, plus 10 to 25 Galleons it had buried, and 50 XP. Three leaves is exactly what Longbottom will ask for on Day 3.
- It never swallows or steals anything. This one is about the noise.

READ ALOUD

You pull. The leaf does not come free. The soil heaves, the pot splits, and something the size of a small child rises out of the earth, wrinkled and root-legged, opens a mouth far too wide for its face, and SCREAMS.

Someone is still wearing their earmuffs from class	They are fine: the first time it hits them, they are not Silenced. Lift the status on the Players tab. Clever.
Someone stuffs its mouth (a Chocolate Frog, a Pasty, a sock)	It chokes on it and skips its next turn, glaring.
The Fenwick talks to it (Green Thumb)	It is terrified, not evil: something has been frightening the plants at night. A CHA 13 calms it for a round. On a natural 20 it stops fighting entirely, burrows back into its pot, and pushes the three leaves out to him as a gift. No fight needed.
They shout for Longbottom	He comes running with an armful of earmuffs, hands them out, and says "Don't hurt it, it's only frightened!" (Earmuffs on: no more Silenced.) He will not fight it for them.

Someone casts Lumos in its face	It hates the light: it shrieks, covers its eyes with its roots, and skips its next attack.
The Thornbury's rats or the Blackwood's spiders	They will not go near it. But a rat whispers: "It was not like this yesterday. Something walked through here last night that smelled of paint."
They run	It cannot leave its soil. It wails after them until the Greenhouse door shuts, and is back in its pot tomorrow, sulking.

ON THE GM SCREEN

Keep it funny and loud: do the scream yourself. It is the comic relief before the night goes dark. The Hungry Trunk is saved for a later day, when they have better things to lose.

The Library

They want a tarot reading	Professor Greaves, behind the velvet curtain: 20 Galleons, one reading per house today. Run it on the **Tarot** tab (how to handle the cards: Guidebook, Day 1 Free time). A reading tonight, of all nights, is a good one to make spooky.
They look for books on paintings	INT 12 finds "Portraiture, aisle nine", and a note that the useful book is in the Restricted Section, which they are not allowed into. Yet.
They find Wren Ashby	Same as Lunch. If they already have a rare card, trade it here (see Card Collector in Part 5).
They look for the Library chest	Empty: the Sinclair opened it yesterday with a natural 20. The lid is still slightly warm, as if pleased with itself.

The mirror's gift: the Silver Memory

Last night they dreamed themselves into the mirror, lit the pedestal together and woke up in their beds. The mirror owes them. Today it holds their reward: **The Silver Memory**, a legendary relic. To claim it, they have to come back to the Library, and (as the Okafor guessed in his diary) they have to come back **together**.

- **The pull:** anyone who walks into the Library today feels the mirror at the end of the stacks, like someone saying their name very quietly. Borish, if asked about the mirror, remembers (on 11 or more): "It keeps what it is given. And it gives back to those who came through it."
- **The glimpse:** in the glass, where their reflections should be, a small vial of silver mist rests on the pedestal from the dream.
- **The alliance:** the glass is hard and cold until a student from **each of the four houses** lays a hand on it at the same time. Then it goes soft as water, and one of them can reach in.

READ ALOUD

Four hands on the cold glass. For a moment nothing happens. Then the mirror sighs, a long breath of air from somewhere very deep, and the glass softens under your palms like the surface of a pool. On the pedestal inside, a small stoppered vial glows with slow silver mist. It is within reach.

Giving it, and using it

- **Who takes it:** whoever reaches in. Let the table decide; it matters who holds it.
- **Give it in the app:** Players tab, that student, **Give a relic**, choose **The Silver Memory**. It appears on their phone as a card with its story, what it does and its drawback.
- **The prop:** a small clay vial with a twist of shiny paper inside (Props Book).
- **Using it:** once, whenever they choose. The holder says they pour it out, and the whole table sees the memory: read the memory from the Props Book (*A memory for the Silver Memory*) slowly, with the lights low.
- **The cost:** whoever pours it is lost in the memory for the rest of the scene and wakes cold and shaking: **−3 HP** (Players tab).
- **After:** the vial is empty. Remove it on the Players tab, or let them keep the empty vial as a keepsake (the prop stays theirs).

TIP

The best moment to pour it is **after** tonight's scream. A painter making a girl in house colours greyer with every stroke, after they have just seen the prefect turned grey: they will put it together themselves. If they pour it before, it is still a great scene, and tonight becomes the confirmation.

Not all four houses come	The glass stays hard. The mirror shows the vial, and four handprints fogging the glass from the inside, waiting. It will wait until they bring everyone.
Someone tries to break the glass	It does not break. It shows them their own reflection, grey from head to toe, for one heartbeat. CON 12 or Frightened for the rest of the block.
They come back at Curfew	The Library is locked, and the ghost is inside. Borish lets them in through the wall if the Fenwick asks.

The Restricted Section

A chained iron gate at the back of the Library. Its lock is old magic and ignores Alohomora. There are only two keys: one on a ribbon round the **librarian's** neck, and one with **the Headmaster**. It stays hidden on the map until someone gets through; when they do, tick them in **Move** and choose **Restricted Section** (or show it on the TV), and it is on the map for good.

READ ALOUD

Behind the last bookcase, where the candles burn lower, an iron gate is wound with chains as thick as your wrist. The padlock is shaped like a closed eye. As you get close, it opens, looks at you, and closes again.

Ways through the gate

The Okafor comes back (Curse-Breaker)	He knows the way now. Under the cloak, past the librarian, hand on the lock: his once-a-day **Curse-Breaker** breaks it outright. The eye opens, weeps a single drop of ink, and the chains slither to the floor. Then spin for the drawback: a little of the curse may stick to him (on a bad spin, his own eyes ache and see everything slightly grey until morning).
They lift the librarian's key	She wears it on a ribbon and never takes it off. DEX 15 to slip it free; with the cloak, roll with advantage. Fail: she grabs a wrist out of thin air, and that is detention. Succeed: it must be back round her neck by Curfew, or she raises the alarm.

They ask the Headmaster for his key	He will not hand it over for curiosity. Tell him the truth (the empty frames, the cold under the castle, the prefect's fear) and CHA 13: he looks at them for a long time, then lends it for one visit. "Bring it back before the candles go out. And whatever you find in there, you tell me first."
They try to pick the lock	DEX 15 with a hairpin. Fail: the eye opens and stares at them, and the librarian looks up from her desk. On a natural 1 the chains rattle loudly enough to wake the portraits.
A teacher's signed note	Shown to the librarian, she sighs and unlocks it herself. Vance signs for a good reason; Ashgrove signs anything, cheerfully (and now Ashgrove knows they went in).
The Penrose wears a prefect's face	The librarian lets a prefect in without a second look. One problem: Prefect Sinclair is the only prefect she knows well, and today, of all days, she might ask how she is.

Inside (Day 2)

READ ALOUD

The air is colder in here, and very still. Books are chained to the shelves by their spines, and they whisper as you pass, every one of them talking at once and none of them loud enough to hear.

Nothing the story needs is here yet: the first page of Vale's diary appears on Day 3, and the page about Corvin Vale on Day 4. Today it is atmosphere, and one roll each. Anyone who reads a chained book rolls a d6:

d6	The book
1	Lives of the Lesser Masters, chained shut. WIS 13: on the contents page, one chapter title has been smudged to "C— V—". The book feels warm, like something alive.
2	It screams when it is opened. CON 12 or ears ringing for an hour, and the librarian is on her way: −5 points if they are caught.
3	Portraits and Their Keeping. One line is underlined: "A portrait is a memory with a door in it."
4	It bites. 1 HP, and it will not let go until someone strokes its spine.
5	It reads you. It whispers one true thing about the reader's family secret, quietly, only to them.
6	Blank pages. Then ink appears, letter by letter: "Not yet. Come back when the third one sleeps."

ON THE GM SCREEN

Pin nothing yet. If they take the C— V— hint to the Headmaster, he goes very quiet: he has heard that name before. If they ask the librarian about the smudged chapter, she says the book has been chained shut for fifty years.

Anywhere else

They go to Ashgrove's classroom	He is marking and hums while he works. Twenty-three paintings. He is pleased to see them and offers biscuits. One frame in the back row is empty, and he has not noticed.
The Blackwood asks the spiders on the Grand Staircase	"The frames are empty. All the frames near the tower. Since sunset. We are leaving." A thin grey line of spiders is moving down the wall, away from Ravenclaw Tower.
The Fenwick runs into Peeves again	Peeves pops out of a suit of armour, upside down. "Polite little Fenwick! Nobody is ever polite to Peeves!" He is fascinated. This is how the Blackwood's name gets cleared: see Part 5.
The Fenwick looks for Borish	He finds him on the Grand Staircase, counting the steps and getting a different number each time. Borish is delighted: "My friend! The one with the map! …Do you have a map?" See Part 5 for what he can (almost) remember.

The table goes quiet	Borish drifts through the wall: “Have you heard? The portraits in the west wing have all gone to visit the Fat Friar. All of them. At once. Most irregular.” Or spin **Hogwarts surprises**.

Curfew: the first victim

Grand Staircase	Filch, Peeves
Library	The ghost
Ravenclaw common room	Prefect Sinclair (placed automatically)
Common rooms	Every student who went to bed

Advance time, then press the button on the Day & class tab that sends every student to their common room. Tonight nobody sneaks out: the doors are locked early (read below).

READ ALOUD

After dinner, the prefects herd every first-year back to their common rooms early. Doors are shut. Portrait holes are sealed. Nobody will say why, but every prefect keeps glancing at the walls, where the paintings sit very still. It is far too early to sleep. In every common room, someone digs out an old game.

The Painted Double: two rounds before the scream

This is the calm before the storm, and it buys you a few minutes to get the scream ready. Everyone plays together, whichever house they are in: the same game is being played in every common room tonight.

- Before the session: on the **Double** tab (the mask), make sure **Portrait | Frame** is in your word list, plus a few of the others below. Use **Add lots at once**, one per line.
- **Round 1, any word:** tick everyone who is playing, leave the Double on random, and in **The word** pick one yourself (Mandrake, say). Random works too, but it might land on Portrait, so picking it yourself is safer.
- **Round 2, Portrait:** same again, and pick **Portrait** in The word. This is the one that ends in the scream.
- Each round: press **Start the round**. Everyone gets the word on their phone except the Double, who gets only the hint.
- Go round the table: each player says **one word** about the secret, out loud. Two rounds is plenty.
- Press **Start the vote**. In round 2, while they vote and argue, step away and get your scream ready.
- Press **Reveal on the TV**. If the Double is caught, they get one guess at the word. Hand out the rewards with one tap (+5 points for everyone who voted right, or +10 to a Double who got away with it).

Word	Hint for the Double	Why tonight
Portrait	Frame	The best one. A minute later, every portrait in the tower corridor is empty.
Mandrake	Earmuffs	This morning’s lesson.
Expelliarmus	Wand	This afternoon’s spell.
Dueling Club	Contest	This evening.
Chocolate Frog	Card	Wren Ashby’s quest.
Prefect	Badge	Too close to home for the Sinclair. Use it only if you want to be cruel.

WAIT FOR THE PLAYERS

Round 2: the moment the result is on the TV and the table is laughing, or arguing about who lied, stop. Let the noise die. Then play the scream.

TIP

No audio of your own? The **Media** tab has a **scream** sound effect. It plays from whatever device your GM screen is on, so turn that speaker up first.

READ ALOUD

And then, from somewhere high up in the castle, a scream.

Who gets there, and how

Ravenclaws (in their common room)	They are closest. They open the door to the corridor and are first on the scene. Go straight to the reveal for them.
Everyone else	The scream throws every common room door open. They have to cross the castle: the Grand Staircase, at night, with the stairs moving. Run the Moving Staircases (below). They arrive when it is solved.
The Sinclair (Fashionably Late)	Whatever house they are in, their gift is made for this. If they use it, they burst into the corridor at exactly the right moment: first to their sister, before anyone else. If they do not, they arrive with their house. Ask them.
Someone stays in bed	Fine. They hear the noise and see teachers running past the door. They can join at the end, or hear it all from a friend in the morning.

Puzzle: The Moving Staircases

READ ALOUD

The Grand Staircase is dark and full of moving shapes. The staircases have swung loose and hang at odd angles over the drop. Far above, a door glows: the way to the tower. If you can line them up, there is a path.

- On the **Puzzles** tab, start **The Moving Staircases**. The pieces appear on the TV.
- They name a piece; you tap it to turn it a quarter clockwise. The path glows when it connects from the arrow on the left to the door on the right.
- Hints: “Start from the arrow and trace one step at a time.” Then: “The path snakes: right, down twice, right, up, right, then down twice to the door.” Last resort: read out the first three turns from the GM panel.
- Solution (clockwise turns, row-column): 1-1 three times, 1-2 three times, 2-2 once, 3-2 twice, 3-3 three times, 2-3 twice, 2-4 twice, 3-4 three times, 4-4 once. Any working route counts.
- Filch and Peeves are on the staircase: every wrong turn that sends a stair crashing round, spin **Out after curfew** for one of them.

TIP

Keep it quick and tense: you are racing a scream. If it drags past ten minutes, a staircase swings into place by itself and the ghost says “This way! Quickly!” The fun is the rush, not the solving.

The scene

ON THE GM SCREEN

Move everyone who arrives to the Ravenclaw common room on the map. Dim the lights in the room if you can. Read slowly.

READ ALOUD

A scream echoes down the corridor outside Ravenclaw Tower. By the time you get there, a crowd of students in pyjamas is standing in a ring around someone lying very still on the flagstones.

It is the Sinclair prefect. Her eyes are open. She is breathing. But she is grey, all of her, as if someone has painted her in shades of ash. Her wand lies beside her hand, and when a teacher picks it up, it crumbles like charcoal.

Along the corridor walls, every portrait is empty.

WAIT FOR THE PLAYERS

Look at the Sinclair player. “What do you do?” Then stop talking. Do not fill the silence. Whatever they do, it is the most important thing anyone does tonight.

The Sinclair goes to her	She is cold. Her eyes do not follow anything. The teachers let the Sinclair stay with her until the matron arrives. Give them the moment. Do not rush it.
Someone looks at the empty frames	“Every portrait near an attack had gone silent.” Pin **“Every portrait near an attack had gone silent”** under The covered painting on the suspect board.
Someone casts Lumos to look for footprints	None. But on the edge of one empty frame: a smear of something wet and dark red, like paint.
The Quill looks around	Every empty frame feels like a held breath. In one, for a heartbeat, they see a painted eye looking back. Tell the Quill privately.
The Okafor feels for curses	“It isn’t a curse. Something took from her. And it isn’t full.” They feel cold to the bone for the rest of the night.
The Penrose is there	Their hair goes grey from root to tip, all at once, and does not change back until morning. Everyone sees it.
The Blackwood asks the spiders	There are none. Not one, in the whole corridor. The cobwebs are empty.
The Thornbury asks the rats	A rat behind the skirting board will not come out. “It came out of the wall. It went back into the wall. It was made of colours.”
The Fenwick looks at the plants	A fern in a pot by the tower door has gone grey too, every frond, like ash.
They accuse someone on the spot	The teachers send everyone to bed. Vance takes their name. The Headmaster looks at them for a long moment and says nothing.

IN CHARACTER: BORISH THE GHOST

Borish comes through the wall behind the Fenwick, looks at the grey girl on the floor, and goes very still. "I have seen this before. A long, long time ago. The colour goes first, and then… then…" He shakes his head, distressed. "I can't remember. Why can't I remember?"

READ ALOUD

Footsteps. The Headmaster arrives in a dressing gown, very slowly, as if each step costs him something. He kneels beside the prefect, looks at her for a long moment, and then up at the empty frames. When he speaks, it is very quiet. "She is alive. Hold on to that. Now, all of you: bed."

ON THE GM SCREEN

Give everyone **The Hollow Heir** (the main quest) on the Quests tab. Close Keep an Eye Out (complete it for anyone who walked with her). This is your cliffhanger: end the session here.

READ ALOUD

That night, nobody in Hogwarts sleeps well. And in every corridor, in every frame, the portraits do not come back.

PART 4

When they go off-script

They will. Here is what to do.

They try to stop the attack (guard her, follow her, stay up)	Let them try; it is a good instinct. But it happens anyway. The lights go out for a single breath, every portrait empties at once, and when the torches come back she is on the floor. What they get for trying: they see a painted hand pulling back into a frame. That is a huge clue. Give it to them.
They go looking for the covered painting tonight	The cold dead end below the Dungeons. Cold air, turpentine, something breathing under the cloth. It says nothing but "Not yet, child. Not yet." Spin Out after curfew on the way back.
They accuse Ashgrove already	Hurt, not angry. "I understand. You are frightened. So am I." He gives them +5 house points for courage. It is the most unsettling thing he does all week.
They accuse Grimsby	He slams his book shut. −5 points. "Get out." The red herring is doing its job; let it.
They skip a class	They miss the lesson (no leaf or no Expelliarmus) and anyone who checks sees them gone. Filch might spot them: spin Out after curfew, even in daylight.
They want to go into the Forest or the Undercroft	Too early for either. The centaur turns them back from the Forest edge ("Not tonight, foal. The stars are wrong."). The Undercroft door is a dead end of cold stone.
They split up into many groups	Fine for Lunch and Free time. Rotate quickly between groups: two minutes each, then the next. Pull everyone back together for Curfew.
Nobody goes near Prefect Sinclair all day	Her owl arrives at the start of Free time. If they still do not go, the Sinclair finds the owl unopened in their bag after the scene. Ouch. That is a story too.

PART 5

Reference for tonight

The people, quests and rules you will need.

Who you will play tonight

Who	Voice and habit	Wants	Hides
Professor Ashgrove	Warm, bright, remembers every name. Leans in to listen. Touches his left cuff before every lie.	To be loved. To be free of the voice in his head.	He brought the painting. Vale uses his hands at night. His portraits are Vale's eyes.
Professor Longbottom	Nervous laugh, talks to plants and apologises to them. Brave the moment someone is in danger.	To save the drained students.	He took down a painting Ashgrove gave him because it kept changing.
Professor Flitwick	Squeaky, fast, stands on books, bounces on his toes, claps at clever answers.	A first-year Dueling Club champion.	He has seen the portraits go silent twice in fifty years. Both times someone died.
Prefect Sinclair	Brisk and protective; laughs things off when scared; ruffles her sibling's hair.	Someone to believe her.	She has dreamed of paintings since summer, and felt the cold under the castle.
Wren Ashby	Talks fast about rarities, ink-stained fingers, lowers her voice for gossip.	One rare Chocolate Frog card.	She knows who signed for the new portraits.
Cassius Thorne	Lazy drawl, flips a Galleon, calls everyone by surname, never sits up straight.	To win.	Half of the Marauder's Map. And he is frightened.
The Headmaster	Slow, long pauses, looks at the ceiling before answering. Answers the worry, not the question.	Every student alive, the school open.	He has heard the name Corvin Vale before.
Professor Greaves	Low, slow, never blinks first. Calls everyone "child". Touches the cards as if they bite.	Twenty Galleons, and an audience.	He will not say why he dislikes the covered painting.

Quests in play

Keep an Eye Out

Given by	Prefect Sinclair (from Day 1 Lunch).
Objectives	Meet her after dinner. Follow her patrol. Find what she is afraid of.
Ends	End of Free time today. Owl if missed.
Reward	30 XP and 10 house points.
Why it matters	It makes tonight hurt. The players who walked with her should feel it when she is on the floor.

Card Collector

Given by	Wren Ashby, from Lunch.
Objectives	Find a rare Chocolate Frog card. Trade it to her.
Where the card comes from	A lucky Chocolate Frog (d20, 18+), an Ancient chest, or The Other Half (Day 4).
Reward	25 XP and Felix Felicis. And her secret: “It came with the new portraits. Ashgrove signed for it himself.”
Clever ideas to allow	Trading her something else rare. A very good fake (INT 14; she always checks the back).

Dueling Club Champion

Given by	Professor Flitwick, from Free time.
Objectives	Beat a rival. Beat two more. Win the final against Cassius.
Today	Only the first rival. One win is a great night.
Reward	40 XP and 15 house points each, at the end.
Why it matters	It teaches the reaction duel, which the villain uses for real in the finale.

The jar: what happens now

Stolen Ingredients is finished, but it ended unfairly, and that is a gift: it gives the Blackwood a grudge, the Penrose a choice, and the Fenwick a strange new friend.

Who got the reward	Grimsby believed the Penrose, so it went to her (30 XP, 10 Galleons, two Pepperup Potions), unless you already decided otherwise at the table. The Blackwood got nothing but a cold stare.
Grimsby and the Blackwood	He is cold to him all day. But the Blackwood’s parting words landed: nobody has spoken to Grimsby like that in years. Secretly, he respects it.
Grimsby and the Penrose	He trusts her now. If she asks him for something today (a hint, an ingredient, a good word), she gets it. That trust is worth something later in the week.
Peeves and the Fenwick	Peeves vanished because nobody is ever polite to him and he did not know what to do. He saw everything: he dropped that jar, and he watched the Blackwood find it.

Clearing the Blackwood’s name (optional, any time today)

The Fenwick asks Peeves, politely, to tell the truth	Peeves cackles, then does it, in the most Peeves way possible: he zooms into Grimsby’s classroom singing “Blackwood didn’t do it, Peeves did it, Peeves did it!” Grimsby goes red. Later he stops the Blackwood in a corridor: “It seems I was… hasty. Five points to your house.” He will not apologise properly. That is as close as he gets.
The Penrose owns up herself	If she goes back to Grimsby and says she might have been wrong: he narrows his eyes, then nods. +5 points to her house for honesty, +5 to the Blackwood’s. And the two of them have something to talk about.
The Blackwood asks the spiders (Spider-Speech)	The spiders in Grimsby’s store cupboard saw it all: Peeves, the shelf, the jar rolling under the cabinet. Spiders cannot testify, but now the Blackwood knows who to lean on.
Nobody does anything	Fine. The grudge stays. On Day 5, when Grimsby is under suspicion, the Blackwood is the one person he will not ask for help, and the one student he quietly hopes will believe him anyway.

ON THE GM SCREEN

Do not force it. The best version is the one the players choose. Whatever happens, write it in your notes: it changes how Grimsby treats both of them for the rest of the week.

The Hollow Heir

Given	To everyone, right after the scene at Curfew.
First objective	Find out what is draining the students.
If they miss it	The Headmaster's owl arrives in the morning.

Borish the ghost

You told the table Borish can find legendary items and point people the right way, if he remembers. Roll a d20 for him whenever they ask: on 11 or more he remembers something true and useful.

Who he is	The castle ghost the Fenwick befriended. A student when Hogwarts was first founded, more than a thousand years ago. Kind, chatty, easily distracted.
Voice	Starts sentences grandly and loses them halfway. Calls the Fenwick "my friend" and everyone else by the wrong name. Counts things when nervous.
His memory	Terrible, but it can be jogged. Each time a student shows him something real (a clue, a place, an object), roll a d20 for him: on 11 or more, a true memory surfaces. On a natural 20, a perfect one.
What he knows (if jogged)	The founders built cellars beneath the cellars, "for the things they did not want found". He saw a painter once, "much later, much much later", who asked the portraits too many questions. And the grey sickness: it happened before, "when the paintings first learned to talk".
What he will not do	Go below the Dungeons. He does not know why. He just won't.
Why it matters	He is the Fenwick's reward for being kind. Use him as the hint-giver when the table is stuck: a jogged memory is a clue that feels earned.

The Fenwick's map

A professor noticed the Fenwick's half of the map on Day 1 and asked to see him. Play the meeting at Lunch or in Free time, whenever he goes.

If it was Ashgrove	Warm and curious, too curious. "What a fascinating old thing. Would you like me to keep it safe for you?" If the Fenwick hands it over, he gives it back the next morning with a faint smell of turpentine, and Vale now knows what it shows. If he refuses, Ashgrove smiles and lets it go. One portrait in the room watches the Fenwick all the way to the door.
If it was anyone else (Flitwick, Longbottom, Vance)	A friendly warning. "I knew the boys who made that. Troublemakers. Good ones." A pause. "Someone older has been asking about a torn map. A Slytherin. Keep it close." If the Fenwick asks how it works: "Its makers were proud of being trouble. It only answers to someone willing to admit they are up to no good."

Can they use the map today?

Yes. The map is not locked to a day: it opens the moment the Fenwick says the right words to it. They are scratched in runes along the torn edge (the puzzle **The Torn Edge** on the Puzzles tab), and the professor's hint points the way.

- **If a player already knows the words** (from the books or films) or guesses them: let it work. That is the reward for knowing. In their Bag, they tap **Open** on the map, then **Speak to the map**, and say them out loud.
- **If they work out some runes by luck or cleverness:** confirm each letter they get right. Puzzles tab, **Rune notebook**: tap a single letter to put it in ink on every phone. If they crack the whole edge, press **They worked out: Half of the Marauder's Map**.
- **Once a day, sixty seconds:** the half shows only the left of the castle (Great Hall, Dungeons, Kitchens, the lake). Agree what you are looking for before it opens.

> **TIP**
>
> If they open it tonight before the scream, look at the left half carefully with them: the Dungeons are there, and below them a dead-end passage the map has drawn but refuses to name. The ink there keeps trying to write two letters, C and V, and smudging them out. They won't know what it means yet.

Spotlight: one moment for every family

Tick a player's sticky note each time they get a moment. At the end of the night, the player with the fewest ticks gets the first scene next session.

Family	Their moment today	When
Sinclair	It is their sister. The whole Curfew scene is theirs. Fashionably Late lets them arrive first.	Curfew
Fenwick	Herbology is his class. The professor's meeting about the map. Borish the ghost. Peeves's new obsession, and the key to clearing the Blackwood.	Morning, Lunch, Free time
Quill	"Every painting in this room." The painted eye in an empty frame tonight. Mirror Self at the Dueling Club.	Lunch, Free time, Curfew
Blackwood	Carrying the jar accusation: the whispers, Grimsby's cold stare, and the chance to clear his name. The spiders will not go near the back row.	Lunch, Free time
Thornbury	Two rune tablets to compare. The Favour of Pentacles on his next chest. A Ravenclaw: first on the scene. The rat that followed the prefect saw "something made of colours".	Free time, Curfew
Penrose	Grimsby trusts her now; does she own up about the jar? Whatever escaped from the suitcase. Her hair goes grey at the scene.	Lunch, Free time, Curfew
Okafor	Day 1's MVP: +2 on every roll today, and his perk. Back to the Restricted Section gate with Curse-Breaker. Searching Ashgrove's desk under the cloak. "It isn't a curse. Something took from her."	Afternoon, Curfew

Rules you will use tonight

Thing	How
Checks	d20 + the stat on the Dice tab. Easy 10, medium 13, hard 16, very hard 19. Advantage: roll two, keep the higher.
Expelliarmus	3 mana. d20 + DEX to hit. On a hit, the target's next attack misses.
Dueling Club rival	14 HP, Defence 12, +3 to hit, 1d6 damage, +2 initiative, 15 XP.
Out after curfew	Spin the wheel for anyone moving about after Curfew. Filch means −10 points and detention.
Tarot	20 Galleons, one reading per house per day. Future upright: a favour. Future reversed: nothing. All upright: two favours. All reversed: cursed.
Secret gifts	Once a day each. Tick "Used today" on the Players tab when they use one.
House points	+5 for something good, +10 for something brilliant, −5 or −10 for rule-breaking.
Healing	The matron heals anyone to full, once per block, in the Hospital Wing.
MVP Badge	Day 1's MVP gets +2 on every d20 roll today (the app adds it) and one perk, used once. Tick it off on the Players tab.

PART 6

Ending the night

Two minutes that save next week.

- End on the cliffhanger. Do **not** press Advance time: next session starts with it, and with a new morning.
- Ask: “What’s the one thing you want to find out tomorrow?” Write the answers down. That is your Day 3 plan.
- Check every player has the main quest, The Hollow Heir.
- **MVP of Day 2:** did anyone meet at least three of the requirements (MVP tab)? If so, crown them now, as the last thing on the TV. If nobody did, say so: it makes the badge worth more. Try not to crown the same student twice in a row.
- On your GM dashboard, press **Back up everything**. Keep the file.
- Click the black game window and press **Ctrl + C** once. Wait for “Game saved”. Then close it.

Coming next session: Day 3

The whole school is whispering. A second student is drained at Lunch, in the Library. Longbottom asks for three Mandrake leaves (the ones from today). Scamander needs help finding a frightened hippogriff with a Thornbury tag. And the Restricted Section opens its first secret. Players who held on to their Mandrake leaf today will be very glad they did.